【10.9 | Economist】Duet forever 永远的二重唱

难度评级：★★★☆☆

**【考研那些事儿之文化系列】**

**今日文章脉络：**

歌唱为人类历史提供了配乐（Para. 1）

↓

唱歌对人生各阶段均有裨益（Para. 2）

↓

很多人都在合唱团歌唱（Para. 3）

↓

但要唱得好很难（Para. 4）

↓

人们也害怕当众唱歌或被评价比较（Para. 5）

↓

团体歌唱则有利有弊（Para. 6）

↓

生活的烦恼对歌声也会有负面影响（Para. 7）

# Why singing is note-worthy, even if you're bad at it

# 唱歌的魅力：为什么不会唱也要唱?

【学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析～】

【Para.1】

Singing has provided a **soundtrack** to human history. Songs tell people about their past and their values. Ancient **epics**, which placed societies in **mythic** time, were sung or **chanted**. "I sing of **arms** and the man," begins **Virgil's** "**Aeneid**"—not "I speak." Singing has long been a way to **bind ideological** communities, from the **hymn**-singing early **Protestants** to pro-**democracy** demonstrators in Belarus.

- **duet n**. /djuˈet/ a piece of music for two players or singers 二重奏（曲）；二重唱（曲）
  a piano duet 钢琴二重奏曲
  （与之对应的 solo 独唱，trio 三重唱）
- **note-worthy adj**. /ˈnəʊtˌwɜːðɪ/ a fact or event that is noteworthy is interesting, remarkable, or significant in some way 值得关注的
  I found nothing particularly noteworthy to report. 我没什么特别值得关注的事情可报告。
- **soundtrack n**. a recording of the musical accompaniment

of a film 电影配乐

- **epic n.** /ˈepɪk/ a long poem about the actions of great men and women or about a nation's history; this style of poetry 叙事诗；史诗

  one of the great Hindu epics 伟大的印度教史诗之一

- **mythic adj.** /ˈmɪθɪk/ that has become very famous, like sb/sth in a myth 著名的；神话般的

  SYN legendary

  Scott of the Antarctic was a national hero of mythic proportions. 南极探险家斯科特是位赫赫有名的民族英雄。

- **chant v.** /tʃænt/ to sing or say a religious song or prayer using only a few notes that are repeated many times 唱圣歌；反复地吟咏祷文；单调重复地唱

- **arms n.** weapons, especially as used by the army, navy, etc. 兵器；武器 【考研大纲词汇】

  arms and ammunition 兵器和弹药

  Police officers in the UK do not usually carry arms. 英国警察通常不携带武器。

- **Virgil n.** 维吉尔（公元前 70-前 19），罗马诗人

- **Aeneid n.** /ɪˈniːɪd/ an epic poem in Latin by Virgil relating the experiences of Aeneas after the fall of Troy, written chiefly to provide an illustrious historical background for Rome 《埃涅伊德》弗吉尔所做的一篇关于特洛伊沦陷后埃尼斯王子经历的宏大诗篇，其创作主要是为罗马城的背景提供史料

- **bind v.** ~ A and B (together), ~ A to B to unite people,

organizations, etc. so that they live or work together more happily or effectively (使) 联合在一起，结合 【考研大纲词汇】

Organizations such as schools and clubs bind a community together. 诸如学校、俱乐部等机构使社区成为一个整体。

- **ideological adj**. relating to principles or beliefs. 意识形态的

  Others left the party for ideological reasons. 其余的人因意识形态原因脱离了该党。

- **hymn n**. /hɪm/ a song of praise, especially one praising God and sung by Christians 赞美诗，圣歌（尤指基督徒唱的颂扬上帝的歌）

- **Protestant n**. /ˈprɒtɪstənt/ a member of a part of the Western Christian Church that separated from the Roman Catholic Church in the 16th century 新教教徒（16 世纪脱离罗马天主教）

  He's a Protestant.他是新教教徒。

- **democracy n**. /dɪˈmɒkrəsi/ fair and equal treatment of everyone in an organization, etc., and their right to take part in making decisions 民主精神；民主权利；民主 【考研大纲词汇】

  the fight for justice and democracy 为正义和民主的斗争

歌唱为人类历史提供了背景音乐。歌曲向人们讲述其过往与价值观。古代史诗将社会置于神话时代，通过吟唱或吟诵的方式流传。维吉尔的《埃涅阿斯纪》开篇写道：“我歌咏战争与英雄”——而非“我讲述”。长期以来，歌唱一直是联结意识形态共同体的纽带，从吟唱赞美诗的早期新教徒，到白俄罗斯的民主示威

者，皆如此。

【Para.2】

It can help people at all stages of life. Singing seems to hold babies' attention, and prevent them from crying, longer than speech. A study published in the British Journal of Psychiatry found that singing groups were better than playgroups at **alleviating** severe **postnatal** depression. The act of singing can help **rehabilitate** people who have suffered **horrendous** injuries, including Gabrielle Giffords, an American **congresswoman** who was shot in the head in 2011. (Music therapy helped her recover verbal fluency.)

- **alleviate v.** /əˈliːvieɪt/ to make sth less severe 减轻；缓和；缓解 【考研大纲词汇】
  SYN ease
  to alleviate suffering 减轻苦难
- **postnatal adj.** /pəʊstˈneɪtəl/ happening after and relating to the birth of a baby 产后的；分娩后的；出生后的
  postnatal depression 产后抑郁症。
- **rehabilitate v.** /ˌriːəˈbɪlɪteɪt/ to help sb to have a normal, useful life again after they have been very ill/sick or in prison for a long time 使（重病患者）康复；使（长期服刑者）恢复正常生活
  a unit for rehabilitating drug addicts 帮助吸毒者恢复正常生

活的机构

- **horrendous adj.** /həˈrendəs/ extremely shocking 令人震惊的；骇人的

  SYN horrific，horrifying

  horrendous injuries 可怕的伤势

- **congresswoman n.** a member of Congress in the US, especially the House of Representatives (尤指美国众议院的) 国会议员

歌唱能让人一生受益。与说话相比，歌唱似乎更能吸引婴儿的注意，并更持久地防止他们哭闹。发表于《英国精神病学杂志》的一项研究发现，在缓解严重产后抑郁方面，歌唱小组优于游戏小组。歌唱行为还能帮助遭受重创的人康复，其中包括 2011 年头部中枪的美国国会女议员加布里埃尔·吉福兹（Gabrielle Giffords）。（音乐疗法帮助她重新正常讲话。）

【Para.3】

Many people **derive** pleasure from singing in **choirs** and other groups. Some 1.5m Germans belong to choirs that are **affiliated** with the main singing associations; millions more sing in casual groups. In “Sing” Sacha Langton-Gilks, a teacher who trained as a **choral** scholar, argues that almost everyone can, and should, sing. But that raises a question.

- **derive v.** /dɪˈraɪv/ to get sth from sth（从...中）得到，获得【考研大纲词汇】

He derived great pleasure from painting.他从绘画中得到极大的乐趣。

- **choir n.** /ˈkwaɪər/ group of people who sing together, for example in church services or public performances（教堂的）唱诗班；（公开演出的）合唱团，歌唱队

  She sings in the school choir. 她是校合唱队的成员。
- **affiliate v.** /əˈfɪlieɪt/ ~ sb/sth (with/to sb/sth) to link a group, a company, or an organization very closely with another larger one 使隶属，使并入（较大的团体、公司、组织）【考研大纲词汇】

  The group is not affiliated to any political party. 该团体不隶属任何政党。
- **choral adj.** /ˈkɔːrəl/ connected with, written for or sung by a choir (= a group of singers)唱诗班的；为唱诗班谱写的；由唱诗班演唱的；合唱的

  choral music 合唱音乐

许多人从参加合唱团及其他团体的歌唱中获得乐趣。约 150 万德国人隶属于各大主要歌唱协会下属的合唱团; 另有数百万人在非正式团体中演唱。在《歌唱》一书中，曾接受合唱学者训练的教师萨莎·兰顿-吉尔克斯（Sacha Langton-Gilks）主张，几乎人人都能够且应该唱歌。但这也引出一个问题。

【Para.4】

If singing is so enjoyable and beneficial, why doesn't everyone do it

more? One answer is that it is extremely difficult to sing well. Good technique must be learned; bad habits must be unlearned. Ms Langton-Gilks was informed by one fierce-sounding teacher that her voice had been "**strangled**" by years of singing in a college choir. Many things can set a singer back: **germs**, **nodules**, the hormone **progesterone** (which dries the **vocal cords**)—and, above all, ageing.

- **strangle v.** /ˈstræŋgl/ to prevent sth from growing or developing 抑制；压制；扼杀

  The current monetary policy is strangling the economy.现行货币政策抑制了经济的发展。
- **germ n.** [ Cusually pl.] a very small living thing that can cause infection and disease 微生物；细菌；病菌 【考研大纲词汇】

  Disinfectant kills germs.消毒剂可杀菌。
- **nodule n.** /ˈnɑːdʒuːl/ a small round lump or swelling, especially on a plant（尤指植物上的）节结，小瘤
- **progesterone n.** /prəˈdʒestərəʊn/ a hormone produced in the bodies of women and female animals which prepares the body to become pregnant and is also used in contraception 孕酮；黄体酮
- **vocal cords n.** [ pl.] the thin strips of tissue in the throat that are moved by the flow of air to produce the voice 声带

如果唱歌如此令人愉悦且有益，为何不是每个人都更多地歌唱呢？答案之一是，唱得好极为困难。良好的技巧必须习得；坏

习惯则必须戒除。兰顿-吉尔克斯女士曾被一位听上去很严厉的老师告知，因多年参加大学合唱团演唱，她的嗓音已被“扼杀”。许多因素都会拖累歌手：病菌、声带结节、孕酮激素（它会使声带干燥）——而最重要的是，衰老。

【Para.5】

Social difficulties **abound** too. Ms Langton-Gilks defends the practice of **auditioning** children for school singing groups, but many children (and adults) fear the exposure and judgment that it **entails**. A request to sing solo in front of others can be no less terrifying than a request to take off your clothes. It might not help that wonderful singers can be **summoned** by a few taps on a phone screen. **Next to** someone like Adele or Caroline Polachek, hardly anybody sounds good.

- **abound v.** to exist in great numbers or quantities 大量存在；有许多 【考研大纲词汇】
  Stories about his travels abound.有关他游历的故事多得很。
- **audition v.** /ɔːˈdɪʃ(ə)n/ ~ sb (for sth) to watch, listen to and judge sb at an audition 对（某人）面试；让（某人）试演（或试唱、试音）
  We auditioned over 200 children for the part.我们为这个角色面试了 200 多名儿童。
- **entail v.** /ɪnˈteɪl/ to involve sth that cannot be avoided 牵涉；需要；使必要

SYN involve

The job entails a lot of hard work.这工作需要十分艰苦的努力。

- **summon v.** /ˈsʌmən/ ~ sb (to sth) to order sb to come to you 召唤

  She summoned the waiter. 她召唤服务员过来。

- **next to** *phrase* in comparison with sb/sth 与...相比

  Next to her I felt like a fraud. 和她相比，我觉得自己是滥竽充数。

社交方面的困难同样不少。兰顿-吉尔克斯女士为学校合唱团选拔儿童试唱的做法辩护，但许多孩子（以及成年人）害怕由此带来的大众审视与评判。被要求当众独唱，其可怕程度不亚于被要求脱掉衣服。轻点几下手机屏幕就能听到顶级歌手的歌声，这恐怕毫无帮助。与阿黛尔（Adele）或卡罗琳·波拉切克（Caroline Polachek）这样的人相比，几乎没有人唱得动听。

【Para.6】

"Sing" insists that group singing is **gratifying** regardless of talent, and that it brings people together. True, but it can also be **infuriating** and **disheartening**. Your correspondent has sung in choirs where people **ostentatiously** turn away or cover an ear to **muffle** the wrong **notes** being sung by a neighbour. One study of an **amateur** choir found that the common practice of bringing in professional singers shortly before

performances, to "**stiffen**" the sound, greatly offended the amateurs. The professionals did not enjoy it, either.

- **gratifying adj**. /ˈgrætɪfaɪɪŋ/ pleasing and giving satisfaction 令人高兴的；使人满意的

  It is gratifying to see such good results. 看到这么好的结果真令人欣慰。

- **infuriating adj**. /ɪnˈfjʊərieɪtɪŋ/ making you extremely angry 使人极为生气（或愤怒）的

  an infuriating child/delay 令人极为生气的孩子；使人愤怒的延误

- **disheartening adj**. /dɪsˈhɑːt ənɪŋ/ if something is disheartening, it makes you feel disappointed and less confident or less hopeful 令人灰心的

  The news was disheartening for investors. 这条消息对投资者来说是令人灰心的。

- **ostentatiously adv**. /ˌɑːstenˈteɪʃəsli/ 招摇地，炫耀地，铺张地

  Her servants were similarly, if less ostentatiously attired. 她的仆人们穿着相似，只是没那么华丽耀眼。

- **muffle v**. to make a sound quieter or less clear 压抑（声音）；使（声音）降低；使听不清

  He tried to muffle the alarm clock by putting it under his pillow. 他把闹钟塞在枕头底下，想减低声音。

- **note n**. a single sound of a particular length and pitch (= how high or low a sound is), made by the voice or a musical

instrument; the written or printed sign for a musical note 单音；音调；音符 【考研大纲词汇】

He played the first few notes of the tune.他演奏了这支曲子开始的几个音。

high/low notes 高/低音

- **amateur adj.** /ˈæmətər/ done for enjoyment, not as a job 业余的 【考研大纲词汇】

  amateur athletics 业余体育运动

- **stiffen v.** /ˈstɪfn/ to make an attitude or idea stronger or more powerful; to become stronger（使）变强硬，变坚定

  SYN strengthen

  The threat of punishment has only stiffened their resolve (= made them even more determined to do sth). 惩罚的威胁益发坚定了他们的决心。

《歌唱》坚称，无论天赋高低，合唱都令人满足，并能使人凝聚在一起。诚然，但它也可能令人火冒三丈、令人心灰意冷。笔者曾在合唱团中演唱，那里有人会刻意转过身去，或捂住一只耳朵，以压低邻座跑掉的歌声。一项针对业余合唱团的研究发现，演出前不久请来专业歌手以“撑起”音色的常见做法，极大地冒犯了业余歌手。专业歌手也并不乐在其中。

【Para.7】

If singing is, or ought to be, an essential part of life, it is not a surprise that life **intrudes** on singing. The **strains** and **irritations** of ordinary

existence can **wreck** people's voices—Ms Langton-Gilks writes that this temporarily happened to her—and throw singing groups into **disharmony**. A better book, with fewer **digressions**, would have more to say about the **bum** notes.

- **intrude v.** /ɪnˈtruːd/ ~ (on/into/upon sth) to disturb sth or have an unpleasant effect on it 扰乱；侵扰 【考研大纲词汇】
  The sound of the telephone intruded into his dreams.电话铃声把他从梦中扰醒了。
- **strain n.** /streɪn/ pressure on sb/sth because they have too much to do or manage, or sth very difficult to deal with; the problems, worry or anxiety that this produces 压力；重负；重压之下出现的问题（或担忧等） 【考研大纲词汇】
  Their marriage is under great strain at the moment. 眼下他们的婚姻关系非常紧张。
- **irritation n.** /ˌɪrɪˈteɪʃən/ irritation is a feeling of annoyance, especially when something is happening that you cannot easily stop or control 恼怒
  He tried not to let his irritation show as he blinked in the glare of the television lights. 在对着耀眼的电视光线眨眼时，他竭力不把自己的恼怒表现出来。
- **wreck v.** /rek/ to wreck something means to completely destroy or ruin it 摧毁 【考研大纲词汇】
  He wrecked the garden. 他毁掉了那个花园。
- **disharmony n.** /dɪsˈhɑːməni/ a lack of agreement about

important things, which causes bad feelings between people or groups of people 不协调；不和谐；不一致

marital/racial/social disharmony 夫妻不和；种族分歧；社会不协调

- **digression n**. /daɪˈgreʃn/ a message that departs from the main subject 离题，题外话；偏离，岔开
- **bum adj**. /bʌm/ of bad quality; wrong or useless 劣质的；错误的；没用的

  He didn't play one bum note. 他一个音也没奏错。

如果歌唱是——或者本应是——生活中不可或缺的一部分，那么生活侵扰歌唱也就不足为奇。日常生活的压力与烦恼会毁掉人的嗓音——兰顿-吉尔克斯女士写道，这种情况曾短暂发生在她身上——并使合唱团陷入不和谐。一本更优秀的书，若少一些题外话，本应对那些跑调的音符有更多论述。

- **今日翻译作业**

(Para. 6) One study of an amateur choir found that the common practice of bringing in professional singers shortly before performances, to“stiffen”the sound, greatly offended the amateurs.

（下一页提供句子分析）

- **今日句子分析**

Para 6. One study of an amateur choir found that the common practice of bringing in professional singers shortly before performances, to “stiffen” the sound, greatly offended the amateurs.

主句 宾语从句

One study of an amateur choir found that the common

主语 定语 谓语 引导词 主语

practice of bringing in professional singers

定语

shortly before performances, to “stiffen” the sound,

时间状语 目的状语

greatly offended the amateurs.

谓语 宾语

句子分析：

主句：

主语-One study；后置定语- of an amateur choir；谓语-found；

宾语从句，作 found 的宾语：

引导词- that ；主语-the common practice ；后置定语-of bringing in professional singers；时间状语- shortly before performances,；目的状语-to “stiffen” the sound,；谓语-greatly offended；宾语- the amateurs.

翻译解析：主句主语长，宾语从句的主语更长（插入语造成主谓分离，例如 to “stiffen” the sound），使得句子容易读乱掉。

先找主干，主句主干：One study of an amateur choir found...一项针对业余合唱团的研究发现……；

宾语从句的主干是：the common practice greatly offended the amateurs 这一常见做法极大地冒犯了业余歌手。

the common practice 意为“这一常见做法”；shortly before performances 时间状语，修饰 bringing in，意为“演出前不久”；the amateurs：宾语，特指前面“业余合唱团”的成员。

- **写作积累**

Para.1 Singing has **long** been a way to bind ideological communities, **from** the hymn-singing early Protestants **to** pro-democracy demonstrators in Belarus.

此处的 long 是副词，意为“长期以来”，强调某种状态持续了很长一段时间，一般会用现在完成时。它相当于 for a long time，但是更简洁，更书面。

而 from A to B 这个表达一般用来列举，且最好 A 和 B 是有较大差别但又都带有某种性质的例子。

类似表达还有：

- Ranging from…to ….，包括……和……，例：She has had a number of different jobs, ranging from chef to swimming instructor. 她做过许多不同的工作，从厨师到游泳教练。
- Spanning…，更强调范围之广，例：The study looks at 42 crises in all, spanning 37countries. 该研究报告观察了 37 个国家的总计 42 场危机。

- Such as… 包括，例：The firm specialized in supplying pieces of equipment, such as terminals, tape drives, or printers. 这家公司专营各种设备配件，比如终端机、磁带机、打印机。

Para.5 A request to sing solo in front of others can be **no less** terrifying **than** a request to take off your clothes.

no less + 形容词/副词 + than 表示“A 在程度上不亚于 B；A 和 B 一样……”，因为这个 no 否定的并非是后面的形容词或副词，而是否定 less，所以其实是肯定用法，例：She's no less capable than the others. 她的能力并不比别人弱。

同理，no less 后面也可以直接跟名词，表肯定，“当然是……”，例：That this is a positive stereotype makes it no less a stereotype, and therefore unacceptable. 这种成见即使是积极的也依然是成见，因而是不可取的。

no more than 则相反，用法更像 only，强调程度低或者数量少，试比较：

He has no less than 100 books.

他有多达 100 本书。(强调多)

He has no more than 100 books.

他只有 100 本书。(强调少)